



Fw: Long Calls and Working Overtime

1 message

Wilbur Matthee <Wilbur.Matthee@medscheme.co.za>

Sat, 06 Dec 2025 at 20:41

To: Wilbur William Matthee <wilburmat@gmail.com>

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From: Wilbur Matthee <Wilbur.Matthee@medscheme.co.za>

To: Mary-Ann Jones <Mary-AnnJ@medscheme.co.za>

Cc:

Bcc:

Date: Wed, 3 Dec 2025 22:32:50 +0200

Subject: Re: Long Calls and Working Overtime

Dear Mary-Ann,

Thank you for your email and the attached departmental adherence policy. I've noted the points regarding long calls, working hours, and overtime.

First, I acknowledge that overtime is not permitted in our department, but this seems inconsistent with the flexible working hours we've been encouraged to adopt, which are meant to enhance productivity. Extending calls to better serve members has always been promoted—why is it now being discouraged?

Second, the 99-minute call was an isolated incident due to complex circumstances, and I emailed you immediately afterward as required.

Regarding the 30-minute average call allocation, please provide the full SOP document so I can familiarize myself with it. Additionally, clarify in writing if calls cannot exceed 30 minutes, as this seems impractical for a healthcare provider where our goal is to deliver the best possible service to members, making us their preferred medical and dental aid provider. Limiting calls this way could pose a risk to our SLAs and overall member satisfaction.

I'm also unclear on why the adherence policy was attached to this email it doesn't appear relevant, Look, I'm trying to follow, but adding "adherence policy" here doesn't make sense—none of these talks about breaks or anything from that doc. Why'd you even attach it? Feels random. Could you explain the adherence connection? It feels out of place and adds to the confusion.

On the topic of burnout, which you mentioned as a reminder, this seems inconsistent with recent directives. The previous week, when I requested to adjust my hours by starting earlier (from 8 to 10 AM) to attend the Employee Health and Safety (EHS) Committee end-of-year function—as the acting chairperson and main organizer—you referenced the Labour Relations Act, stating I couldn't travel during lunch hours or shift my schedule, citing SOP restrictions on working more than two hours back per week to avoid burnout. This forced me to attend only briefly about 20mins, wasting personal funds on an Uber to and from Woodstock, and return to my workstation prematurely, which was embarrassing and unproductive.

Yet, the following week, you instructed me to work back four hours, resulting in 11-hour days on Tuesday and Thursday. What happened to the SOP on limiting extra hours to prevent burnout? This selective application of policies enforcing them strictly when it suits you but ignoring them otherwise doesn't make sense and feels targeted, especially toward me.

Furthermore, any overtime worked should not be "to my own account." I do not agree with this, as it constitutes a unilateral change and could be seen as an unfair labor practice. If this is the policy, please provide formal documentation stating it applies to everyone in the department, not just selectively. I'd also appreciate management's input on this to ensure fairness.

This blanket approach to management is contributing to low team morale everyone seems unhappy working under this guidance. It's like smiling with the front teeth while chewing with the back ones; it erodes trust and collaboration. Teams that truly collaborate and align on values like integrity, innovation, and support deliver the best service to members, but that's not happening here.

I look forward to your clarifications to align on clear, consistent expectations moving forward. I am refusing any further unnecessarily stress from you.

I have taken you up on your do not react but respond, as it appears the teacher is failing and appears bias.

Best regards,

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From: Mary-Ann Jones <Mary-AnnJ@medscheme.co.za>
Sent: Wednesday, December 3, 2025 5:26:48 PM
To: Wilbur Matthee <Wilbur.Matthee@medscheme.co.za>
Cc: Mary-Ann Jones <Mary-AnnJ@medscheme.co.za>
Subject: Long Calls and Working Overtime

Good day Wilbur

Please find departmental adherence policy attached as previously sent. Communication below regarding our conversation we had regarding long calls and working overtime.

- Email confirmation received that 169 minutes is owed for working overtime for November 2025 due to long calls that did not end on time.
- We had a meeting and explored the areas added to the time sheet for long calls.
- Average time allocation for calls is 30 minutes -should the call with the member be during working hours then only the difference of the time need to be added to the time sheet with the member number and dependent code as reference for audit purposes.
- No overtime is allowed in our department as we are an outbound call centre.
- Please don't make calls to members 15 minutes before the working hour end - rather attend to admin tasks during that time eg cybersmart, emguidance course, etc to ensure that you do not work over your allocated time.
- Should you work over your allocated working hours then it will be for your own account going forward -reminder that burnout can happen if too many hours worked.
- Long calls with members outside of working hours is discouraged as it affects us operationally.
- Any overtime/working outside of your normal working hours need to be communicated with your team leader as soon as possible.
- Should you be in a call with a member please send an email to me as soon as possible after in order for me to acknowledge it at the soonest possible time.
- Working overtime also need to be communicated with your team leader before if at all possible in order for approval to be given.
- Accumulated time needs to be taken off in the same month and may not be carried over to the following month as per departmental adherence policy.

Kind Regards



Mary-Ann Jones

Team Leader: GEMS Active Disease Risk Management

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